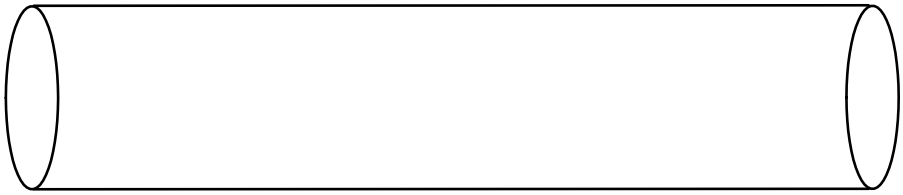
Sec 12.3

Tuesday, May 19, 2015 4:15 PM

Section 12.3
Boundary Conditions describe what is happening on the boundary! For the 1-d heat equation we typically have three types of Boundary conditions.

Prescribed temperature at the ends:



Sec 12.3

Tuesday, May 19, 2015 4:23 PM

Prescribed flux at the ends:



Sec 12.3

Tuesday, May 19, 2015 4:15 PM

Newton's Law of Cooling $\phi(t) = -H(T_{object} - T_{air})$



Sec 12.4 Equilibrium Temperature Distribution(steady state)

Wednesday, May 20, 2015 4:57 PM

Of interest in many physical problems is what we call the equilibrium state or steady state. This is the state where a system stops undergoing change.

Let's apply this to the 1-d heat equation. $\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = k\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + Q$ with $Q = 0$

If we are in equilibrium this means that the temperature is no longer changing or that $\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = 0$

Thus we have the now ODE

$$\frac{d^2u}{dx^2} = 0$$

We will still have an initial condition
$u(x, 0) = f(x)$

Whether or not we will need the initial condition will depend on our boundary conditions.

Let's first consider Dirichlet boundary conditions(prescribed temperature at the ends)

$$u(0, t) = T_1 \text{ and } u(L, t) = T_2$$

We then want to solve the ODE : $\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} = 0$ with boundary conditions $u(0, t) = T_1$ and $u(L, t) = T_2$

Sec 12.4

Wednesday, May 20, 2015 5:23 PM

Insulated boundaries:

Let' solve the same problem but with insulated end boundary conditions. BCs: $\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}(0) = 0 \ \ and \frac{\partial u}{\partial x}(L) = 0$

With an initial condition of $u(x, 0) = f(x)$

First let's think about it…



Sec 12.4

Wednesday, May 20, 2015 5:31 PM

Homework example.

From sec 12.4 Problem 1 part (f)

Determine the equilibrium temperature distribution for a one dimensional rod with the following sources and boundary conditions.

$$\frac{Q}{K_0} = x^2\,, \qquad u(0) = T_1\,, \qquad \frac{\partial u}{\partial x}(L) = 0$$

Sec 12.4

Wednesday, May 20, 2015 5:37 PM

Home Work Example

From Sec 12.4 Problem 4

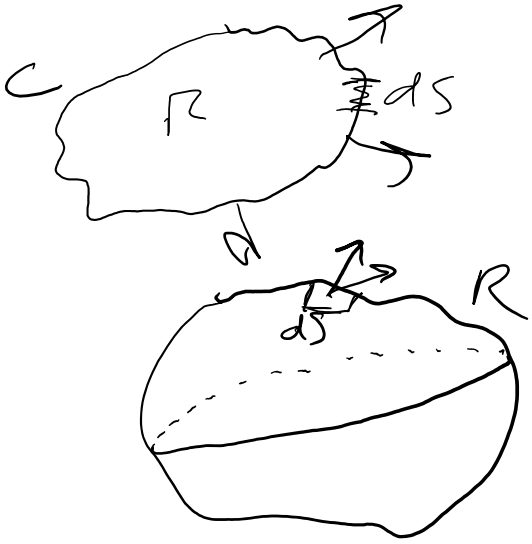
If both ends of a rod are insulated show, using the partial differential equation , that the total thermal energy in the rod is constant.

Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Wednesday, May 20, 2015 5:39 PM

We will start this derivation with the idea of conservation of energy for the total thermal energy inside an arbitrary region R. The total thermal energy in R is

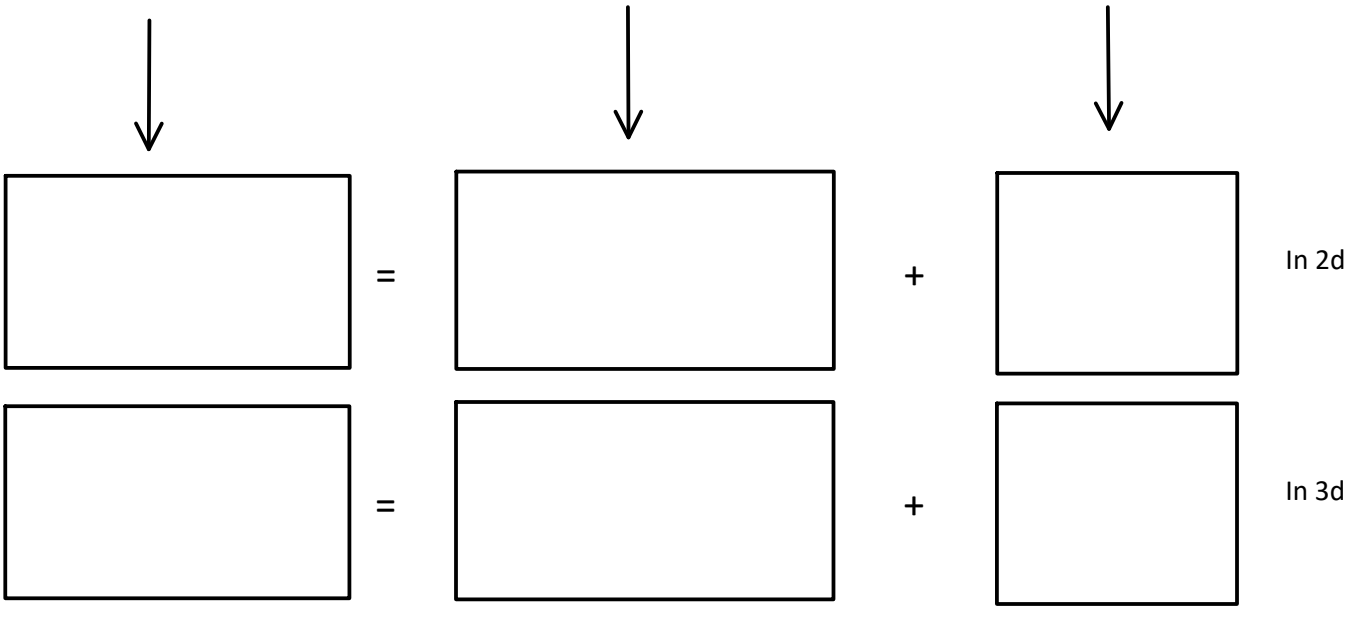
$$E = \int_S e(x,y,t)dS = \int_S c(x,y)\rho(x,y)u(x,y,t)dS \quad In\ 2d$$



$$E = \int_V e(x,y,z,t)dV = \int_V c(x,y,z)\rho(x,y,z)u(x,y,z,t)dV \quad \text{in 3d}$$

Conservation of energy then states:

Time rate of change of heat energy = Heat energy flowing across The boundaries per unit time + Heat energy generated or lost Inside per unit time



We would like everything in terms of a volume integral if we can. To that end recall our favorite divergence theorem.

$$\int_A \vec{F}\cdot\vec{n}dS = \int_V \nabla\cdot\vec{F}dV\ in\ 3d \qquad \text{or} \qquad \int_C \vec{F}\cdot\vec{n}ds = \int_S \nabla\cdot\vec{F}dS\ in\ 2d$$

Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 2:36 PM

We will do this in 3d as the derivation is the same in 2d.

Our conservation of thermal energy equation states:

$$\frac{d}{dt}\int_V c\rho u dV = -\int_S \vec{\phi}\cdot\vec{n}dS + \int_V Q dV$$

Applying the divergence theorem($\int_A \vec{F}\cdot\vec{n}dS = \int_V \nabla\cdot\vec{F}dV$) to our surface integral gives us:

Passing the time derivative into the volume integral gives us:

Moving all the integrals to one side we obtain:

Because this is an integral over an arbitrary volume we may say:

Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 2:46 PM

Now we have a continuity equation

$$c\rho\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = -\nabla\cdot\vec{\phi} + Q$$

but just like in the 1d case we have two different functions namely u *and* $\vec{\phi}$.

To obtain a PDE in terms of just the temperature u we again appeal to Fourier and his law of heat conduction.

Fourier's Law of heat conduction in 2d and 3d

$$\vec{\phi} = -K_0\nabla u$$

Let's pause to examine this law physically and mathematically for a moment.

You might recall the definition of the directional derivative from Calc III

$D_{\vec{v}}f = \nabla f\cdot\vec{v}$ where $\vec{v}$ is a unit vector. This measures how much f is changing in the direction of $\vec{v}$

We can write $\nabla f\cdot\vec{v} = \big|\big|\nabla f\big|\big|\,||\vec{v}||\cos(\theta)$

Thus we can see if $\theta = 0$ we have the greatest rate of increase of f and if $\theta = 180$ We have the greatest rate of decrease.

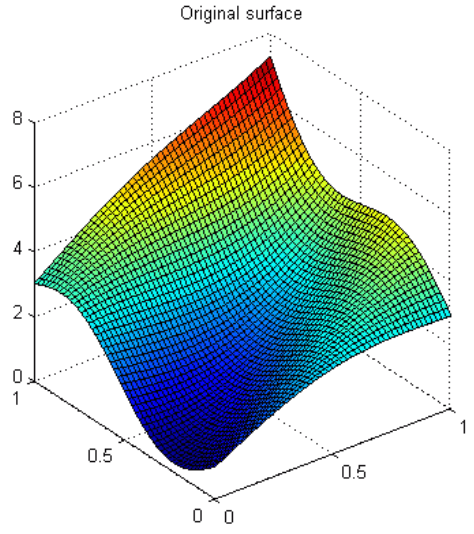
Note that when $\theta = 0$ $\nabla f\cdot\vec{v} = \big|\big|\nabla f\big|\big|\big|\vec{v}\big|\big|\cos(0) = \big|\big|\nabla f\big|\big|(1)(1) = ||\nabla f||$

When $\theta = 180$ $\nabla f\cdot\vec{v} = \big|\big|\nabla f\big|\big|\big|\vec{v}\big|\big|\cos(\theta) = \big|\big|\nabla f\big|\big|(1)(-1) = -||\nabla f||$

So then here the direction of greatest decrease of the scalar function f is the opposite of the gradient or $-\nabla f$

If f happens to be a temperature field and if heat flows from hot to cold, we would expect the flux to follow the negative gradient! In math speak:

$$\vec{\phi} = -K_0\nabla u$$



Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 3:15 PM

Back to the Derivation.

We have: $c\rho \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = -\nabla \cdot \vec{\phi} + Q$ and $\vec{\phi} = -K_0 \nabla u$

To finish off our derivation we only need substitute Fourier's law into out continuity equation

Again if ρ , c and K_0 are constant we can divide by ρ and c and pull K_0 out of the deravitive for a simplier heat equation.

Behold! The Heat Equation in 2-d or 3d!!

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = k\nabla^2 u + Q$$

Recall that: $\nabla^2 u = \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial y2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial z^2}$

Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 6:55 PM

Initial and Boundary conditions in 2-d and 3-d

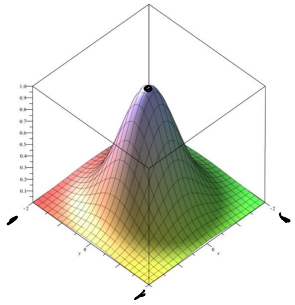
We will still have some kind of initial condition at time $t = 0$ which will represent the initial temperature distribution.

In 3d: $u(x, y, z, 0) = f(x, y, z)$ in and on the boundary of the region of intrest

I can't draw a 4 dimensional surface :(

In 2d: $u(x, y, 0) = f(x, y)$ in and on the boundary of the region of interest

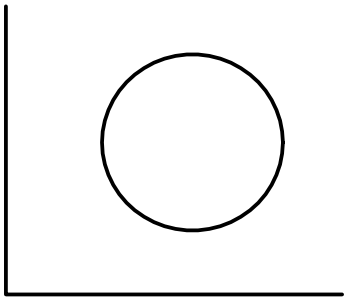
As an example suppose the initial temperature distribution looked like $f(x, y) = e^{-x^2-y^2}$

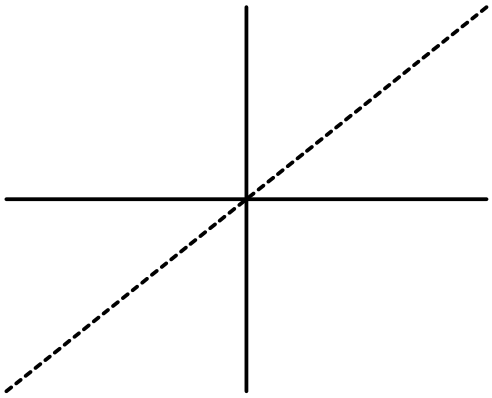


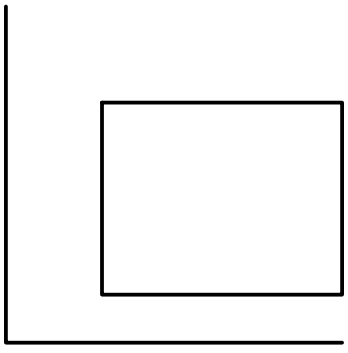
Boundary Conditions:

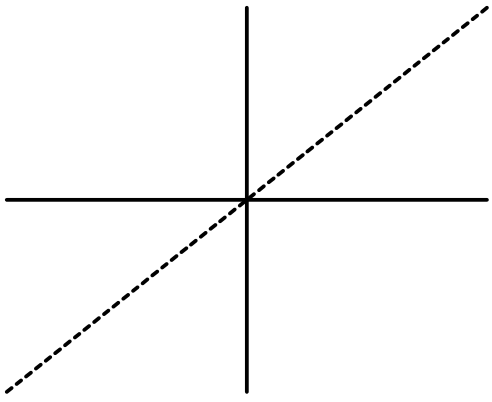
Direchlet (specified temperature on the boundaries)

$$u(x, y, z, t) = T(x, y, z, t) \ \ for \ (x, y, z) \in \partial R$$









Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 7:05 PM

Neumann Boundary condition: Specifying the flux at the boundary. $\vec{\phi} \cdot \vec{n} = f(x, y, z, t)$ for $(x, y, z) \in \partial R$

Recall from Fourier that $\vec{\phi} = -K_0 \nabla u$ thus $\vec{\phi} \cdot \vec{n} = -\mathrm{K}_0 \nabla \mathrm{u} \cdot \vec{\mathrm{n}} = f(x, y, z, t)$

We usually just divide by $-K_0$ and absorb it into the left hand side for what ever function we have. In this way flux boundary conditions are often written interms of just the gradient and the normal vector.

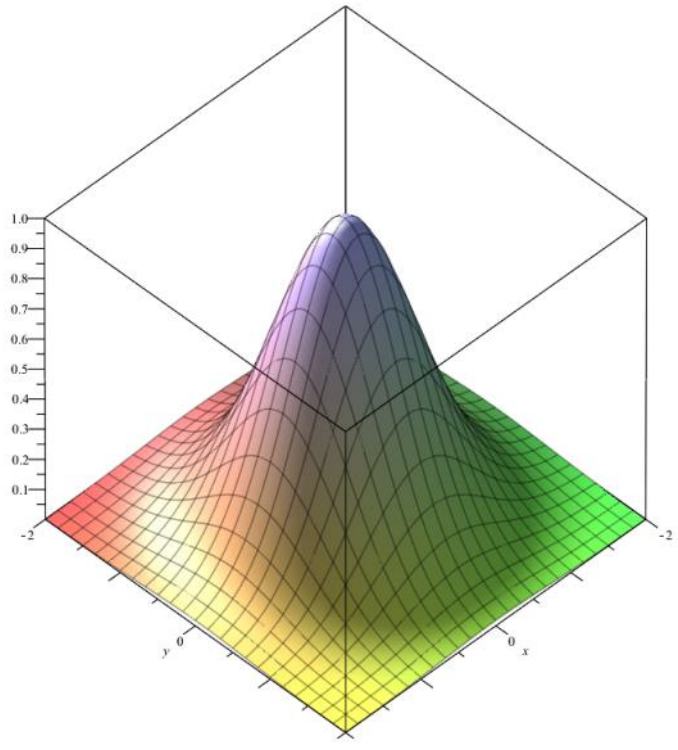
$$\nabla u \cdot \vec{n} = f(x, y, z, t) \quad \text{or in another common notation} \quad \frac{\partial u}{\partial \vec{n}} = f(x, y, z, t)$$

Keep in mind this is only on the boundary of the region of intrest often denoted ∂R

Let's think about what an insulated boundary means. $\nabla u \cdot \vec{n} = 0 \quad for\ (x, y, z) \in \partial R$

Let's suppose we are in 2d and are interested in the region defined by: [-2,2]X[-2,2] and have the initial temperature distribution $u(x, y, 0) = f(x, y) = e^{-x^2 - y^2}$

If there is no flux($\nabla u \cdot \vec{n} = 0$) at the boundary what will the solution at equilibrium look like?



Let's watch it happen!

Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 3:21 PM

Equilibrium solutions to the heat equation.

Let's first look at the case where we have no heat sources($Q = 0$) in the volume on interest and let's assume everything is in equilibrium $\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = 0$

$$\textit{The heat equation } (\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = k\nabla^2 u + Q) \textit{ then becomes:} \quad \mathrm{k}\nabla^2 u = 0$$

$$\text{Or:} \qquad \nabla^2 u = 0$$

This is what we call Laplace's equation which we will learn to solve later.

If there is an internal source of heat $Q \neq 0$ ut we assume equlibrium $\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = 0$ then we obtain what is called Poisson's equation

$$\nabla^2 u = -\frac{Q}{K_0}$$

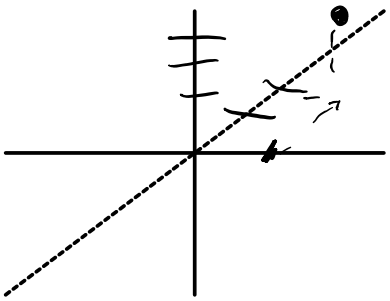
Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 7:38 PM

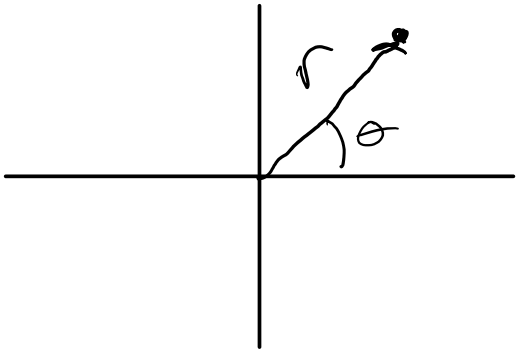
A look at the Laplacian in other coordinate systems.

Depending on the geometry of our problem we may want to use a specific coordinate system. Thus we will need to know that $\nabla^2 u$ looks like in what ever coordinate system we choose.

In Good 'ol Cartesian: $\nabla^2 u = \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial y2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial z^2}$

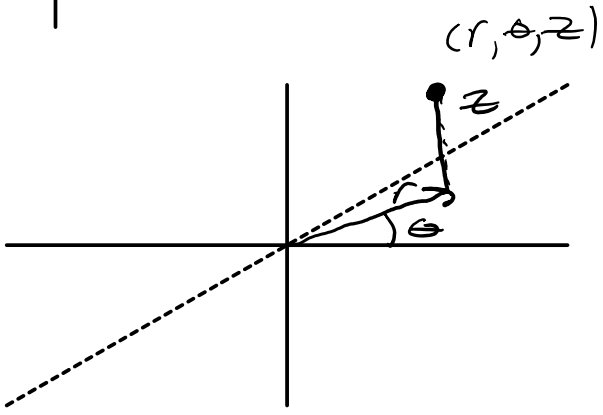


In polar(2d): $\nabla^2 u = \frac{1}{r}\frac{\partial}{\partial r}\left(r\frac{\partial u}{\partial r}\right) + \frac{1}{r^2}\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial \theta^2}$



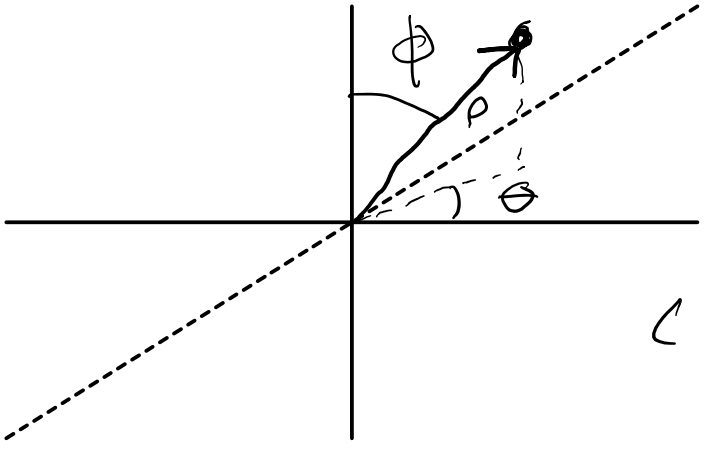
In Cylindrical: $\nabla^2 u = \frac{1}{r}\frac{\partial}{\partial r}\left(r\frac{\partial u}{\partial r}\right) + \frac{1}{r^2}\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial \theta^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial z^2}$

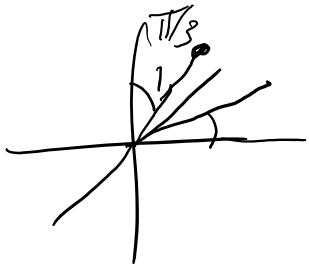
(r, θ, z)



In Spherical: $\nabla^2 u(\rho, \theta, \phi) = \frac{1}{\rho^2}\frac{\partial}{\partial \rho}\left(\rho^2 \frac{\partial u}{\partial \rho}\right) + \frac{1}{\rho^2 \sin(\phi)}\frac{\partial}{\partial \phi}\left(\sin(\phi)\frac{\partial u}{\partial \phi}\right) + \frac{1}{\rho^2 \sin^2 \phi}\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial \theta^2}$

(ρ, θ, ϕ)





$(1, \pi/4, \pi/3)$

Sec 12.5 Heat Equation in 2-d or 3-d

Thursday, May 21, 2015 7:53 PM

Homework Examples:

Let $u(r,\theta,z) = z + rsin(\theta)$ calculate $\nabla^2 u$

In Cylindrical: $\nabla^2 u = \frac{1}{r}\frac{\partial}{\partial r}\left(r\frac{\partial u}{\partial r}\right) + \frac{1}{r^2}\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial \theta^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial z^2}$

Let $u(\rho,\theta,\phi) = \rho + \sin(\theta) + \cos(\phi)$ calculate $\nabla^2 u$

In Spherical: $\nabla^2 u(\rho,\theta,\phi) = \frac{1}{\rho^2}\frac{\partial}{\partial \rho}\left(\rho^2\frac{\partial u}{\partial \rho}\right) + \frac{1}{\rho^2\sin(\phi)}\frac{\partial}{\partial \phi}\left(\sin(\phi)\frac{\partial u}{\partial \phi}\right) + \frac{1}{\rho^2\sin^2\phi}\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial \theta^2}$